

It's often happened in shooters that you'd end up killing wayward team-mates if they ended up in your way during a battle. To ensure the safety of your buddies, EIB forbids this—point at them and shoot, and all you get is a click and a big “Not Allowed” symbol.

An annoying thing about being in battle is that the guns are awfully inaccurate. You're supposed to look down the barrel of the gun to get better aim, but all you end up getting is a close-up of your gun—you can barely see the guy you want to shoot!

Another gripe is that when you've emptied all your bullets, you need to release the mouse button and click it again to reload. Many a time, you don't even realise that your clip's empty till you try to shoot someone and find yourself going through the motions of reloading your weapon. The result?

Self: Assault! Blaaaa! We're gonna kill you al...[click!] Darn!

German: [Miscellaneous German Sounds!] [Bang!] Haha!

Self: Uhhh...

Tour de France

The game has you playing in smallish parts of French towns and the countryside. Everything is quite well-detailed, but the maps are too restrictive. It's surprising how you aren't allowed to jump over walls that are barely waist-height, or even walk through bushes! We're still hoping for a WWII shooter that allows for some more freedom.

The graphics in the game aren't too great—at least, not comparable to most shooters today. Nevertheless, some really well-done texturing ensures that it's still quite pleasing to the eye. And really, it doesn't matter—the gameplay more than makes up for any shortcoming in the graphics. Environmental sounds are what you would expect them to be—you can hear random gunfire in the background, bullets whizzing past you and thudding into the ground, and the occasional anti-aircraft battery. The guns sound incredible, even on a regular 2.1 speaker system. The US BAR sub-machine gun has a brilliant bass thump, as does the German MG 42 machine gun.

Fall In!

Brothers in Arms: Earned in Blood is a really good game—more so if you actually like WWII shooters. The AI is good, the sound is good, it looks pretty, has some intense action with choice amounts of gore, and is rife with some fun abuses you wouldn't want anyone below 17 hearing. Seven on ten for this one, because the many, many annoyances mar the whole experience. ■

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Publisher: Activision

Minimum System Configuration: Pentium IV 1.4 GHz or AMD

Athlon 1700+, 256 MB RAM, 64 MB DirectX 9.0c compatible card

Price: Rs 1,299

Distributed in India by World Wide CD ROMs

Tel: 022 - 56973894



As the battle raged higher



And though they did hurt me so bad, In the fear and alarm



I've witnessed your suffering...



You did not desert me, My Brothers in Arms...